

Registrar's Office Curriculum Review Guide (Graduate Programs)

1. Effective term & catalog edition

1.1 — The effective catalog edition must match the effective term. A Fall YYYY effective term maps to the YYYY–(YYYY+1) catalog edition.

1.2 — Program-requirement changes take effect on a catalog-year (Fall) basis only. A requirement change cannot be effective mid-year (e.g. Spring); the effective term is moved to the next Fall.

1.3 — There is an annual college-approval deadline per catalog year; miss it and the proposal rolls to the next edition. The Registrar moves the edition forward when the deadline has passed.

1.4 — New degree programs needing Faculty Senate / Board approval may be pushed to a later term/edition, but can be included in a catalog *addendum* if fully approved before publication.

1.5 — The effective term is set to the earliest term still achievable given remaining approvals and deadlines (e.g. a missed Fall becomes the next Spring only if a requirement change isn't involved — see 1.2).

1.6 — A successor / "exit" program's effective term is set so it directly follows the predecessor's last active catalog (no gap or overlap between the old program's final catalog and the successor's first).

1.7 — Added options may apply retroactively; removed options do not. Newly-added course options can be applied retroactively (students already in the program may use them); *removing* an option or changing a requirement takes effect only from the future catalog term, so students who already completed a dropped course keep credit for it. Whether a change applies to already-admitted students is decided at Program Review 2.

2. Program title & naming

2.1 — Campus-specific program records must carry the campus in the full program title, in parentheses. Per the Registrar's "campus-specific records project."

2.2 — Degree and campus are both reflected in the full program title.

2.3 — Minors do NOT carry a campus parenthetical.

2.4 — Online program titles follow the standard "(Online)" convention. The special "(Online – Vancouver Requirements)" form is a one-off regulatory case and should **not** be used as a model for new online programs.

3. Program overview language

3.1 — Remove implied promises of student achievement / outcomes.

3.2 — Do not imply the curriculum includes remedial or undergraduate coursework.

3.3 — Overview must state whether a concentration is optional or required, consistently with the requirements. If optional, say "optional"; if a single mandatory concentration, integrate it into the text.

3.4 — Overview links for multi-campus programs must point to the network-wide listing, not a single campus.

4. Concentrations

4.1 — If a concentration is not required to complete the program, the heading is not "Concentrations." It becomes "Concentration or Electives Option," and instructions like "Complete one of the following concentrations" are removed.

4.2 — The internal-use "Concentration(s)" field must be populated, including **NOCC (No Concentration)** when none is required, and the "Can students choose this concentration at the time of admission?" flag set consistently across the program's concentrations.

4.3 — Inactive courses inside a concentration must be resolved before approval (proposal is routed back to the college dean's office to fix).

4.4 — Concentration requirements should be consistent across a program's campus deployments (align non-Boston records to the Boston record).

5. Credit hours

5.1 — The catalog publishes only the MINIMUM hours required to complete the program — ranges like "34–35 SH" become "34 SH". Exception: Align/Bridge/Connect programs, which may legitimately require more.

5.2 — Restricted-elective / choice language uses "at least N SH" / "a minimum of N SH," not a range.

5.3 — Remove "maximum of N semester hours" statements. The catalog documents the minimum for completion; students may exceed it where options allow.

5.4 — Credit hours must be semester hours (SH), not quarter hours (QH). QH references are corrected (part of the CPS semester conversion).

5.5 — For "choose N SH from the following" requirements, put the hours in the dedicated hours field and indent the options so credit is associated with the requirement, not shown per-option. Conversely, **core-requirement courses are un-indented** so their hours display.

5.6 — A course's credit value in the program must match the course's own approved credits (e.g. a course approved at 3 SH is shown as 3 SH in the program, not 5).

5.7 — The "Overall credits required for the degree" field holds the minimum required (not a range) — same rule as 5.1, applied to that specific field.

6. Committee routing (UGCC / UGCC / Graduate Council)

6.1 — Any change to core requirements must be routed to UGCC (graduate).

6.2 — Adding courses from other colleges (or adding/removing a college's course from a UIP) requires UGCC review.

6.3 — A "Course Not Found" error in a curriculum clears once the referenced new course is approved by UGCC — it is not a defect to fix in the program proposal.

6.4 — Online programs do not require GRA review and are routed to the Registrar's degree-audit team instead.

7. Admission, inactivation & teach-out

7.1 — Set "Is this program open for students applying through admissions?" correctly — but note PlusOne students are admitted via Slate, so a program admitting PlusOne students must remain "Yes" even if not open to external applicants.

7.2 — An inactivation proposal is held until its successor new-program proposal is ready; both advance to the same UGCC meeting.

7.3 — The "Final Catalog" field on an inactivation must match the inactivation's effective term. Inactivated as of Fall 2025 -> final catalog 2024-2025 (not 2025-2026).

8. Degree audit, CIP codes & campus/modality

8.1 — CIP code and campus/modality fields are set by the Registrar's degree-audit team on new program records (an administrative step, not a college action).

8.2 — An online program flipping BOS -> Online (VTL) for 2026-2027 is not a genuinely new program, even though CourseLeaf tags it "New Program Proposal" — it's the creation of the VTL-campus record. Registrar adds the Banner program/major code and existing CIP.

8.3 — Dual-degree programs have no degree-audit impact and skip that step.

8.4 — Credit-bearing experiential-learning courses that also satisfy an elective must be listed in the electives list for degree audits to function.

9. Grade / GPA requirements

9.1 — Minimum-grade statements at core requirements use the college's standard wording. For COE: "The College of Engineering requires that students must earn a grade of C or higher in all required core courses..." — added/normalized per college request.

9.2 — Prerequisites outside the program should not be required for core courses. The minimum-grade statement is simplified to "A grade of C or higher is required for each of the following courses."

9.3 — Don't add "prerequisite conditions may require a higher minimum grade" when the program has only one core course (the sentence is dropped as inapplicable).

10. Prerequisites

10.1 — When elective options require prerequisites outside the program, add the standard alert language and ensure there are completion pathways that don't require the external coursework.

11. Experiential learning / co-op

11.1 — If co-op/experiential participation adds hours or tuition, the Program Requirements must alert students.

11.2 — Optional experiential learning is placed in a dedicated "Optional Experiential Learning Opportunities" area (added with college authorization).

11.3 — Non-credit / non-existent co-op prep courses are removed from the curriculum. A line is deleted if the course was never created or awards no credit.

12. Thesis / capstone

12.1 — Zero-credit special-purpose courses (Thesis Continuation, Research) are removed from elective lists — they don't award credit toward the elective hours.

12.2 — A heading offering "Thesis" must reflect what is actually offered — e.g. "Capstone or Thesis" -> "Capstone or Project" when thesis is no longer an option.

12.3 — A thesis sequence that relies on a repeatable course requires that course to be UGCC-approved as repeatable first.

13. Dual / joint degrees

13.1 — Dual-degree programs have no standalone degree-audit impact (see 8.3) but changes to shared credits still go to UGCC.

13.2 — Dual-degree catalog URLs get a redirect established by the Registrar when program pages move.

14. Curriculum-list hygiene

14.1 — No duplicate courses in a list; electives are kept in alphanumeric order.

14.2 — Inactive ("red-boxed") courses must be resolved by the college before approval; the Registrar removes inactive courses from requirement options.

14.3 — Lines for courses that don't exist are removed (phantom courses that were never created).

14.4 — A mistyped or wrong course reference is corrected to the intended course (e.g. CMN 6600 -> CMG 6600; PHTH 6440 -> PHTH 7440, with the owning unit's authorization).

14.5 — Courses deactivated in the annual NECHE course-deactivation review are removed from options as of the effective term of the deactivation.

15. Requirements structure, headings & formatting

15.1 — Remove headings that have no associated content (e.g. a "Coursework Option" heading with nothing under it).

15.2 — Don't use headings or instructions that imply a choice that doesn't exist. "Core A" / "Core B" subheadings are removed when there is no choice of core; "Complete one of the following" is removed when only one option exists.

15.3 — Group course options under the college that owns them (e.g. a CAMD course under CAMD, an IE course under COE).

15.4 — Footnotes belong at the bottom of the relevant requirements table, with footnote formatting — not as trailing body text after the electives.

15.5 — Remove core-requirement subtotals per current catalog practice.

15.6 — Don't let formatting merge distinct requirements (e.g. a "Restricted Electives" block accidentally folded into Core), and don't indent core courses in a way that hides credits or implies every listed course is required.

15.7 — Heading renames that change meaning are done in consultation with the Provost's Office (e.g. "Project Option" -> "Project Pathway").

16. Modality & campus designation

16.1 — Use "Online" only when the program is fully online; use "Primarily Online" when any component must be in person (e.g. an internship, residency, or on-ground requirement). If an "Online" program has an in-person requirement, it should be re-designated Primarily Online.

16.2 — Online programs use the campus "Online" and do not name a specific city/NU campus (a Vancouver-serving online program is still just "Online").

16.3 — Set the Campus / Modality field to match actual delivery (e.g. Boston -> Primarily Online) when the college confirms the modality.

17. Instructional-method statement

17.1 — Programs whose class sections span campuses or instructional methods carry the standard catalog statement: "Class sections of courses required for this program may be offered at multiple campuses and in multiple instructional methods. Students should carefully review class section instructional method and, as needed, review class section campus at the time of registration." This mirrors the university's [instructional-methods policy](<https://catalog.northeastern.edu/graduate/academic-policies-procedures/instructional-methods/>).

18. Shared content

18.1 — Colleges are responsible for adding the shared-content area to a proposal where appropriate (per the Catalog/Registrar instructions for programs in workflow).

19. Proposal setup & workflow

19.1 — A certificate should comprise multiple courses/modules — a single-course "certificate" is questioned.

19.2 — New degree programs must have an executive summary attached for Office of the Provost, Faculty Senate, and Board of Trustees review before the proposal is approved out of the college dean's office.

19.3 — Set "Is there a subject code associated with this program?" to the program's own subject — this auto-includes the program director in the approval workflow for future changes.

19.4 — New program proposals and substantial program changes receive IPD (Innovation Planning & Development) review at the start of workflow on behalf of university leadership.

19.5 — A change-of-academic-unit proposal starts in the "relinquishing" college, after which the Office of the Provost coordinates subsequent college reviews.

Companion files: registrar_rules.json (machine-readable checks) and registrar_comments.xlsx (all comments by commenter and program; a Registrar flag column marks the Registrar's Office authors).